Prominent Arabic-era astrologers include: Nawbakht the Persian, Theophilus of Edessa, Masha'allah from Basra, Omar Tiberiades of Persian descent, Abu Ali al-Khayyat, Sahl ibn Bishr, Abu Ma'shar, Al-Kindi, Abu-Bakr, Al-Rigal, and Al-Biruni.[2]

Transmission. While astrology flourished brilliantly between the seventh and tenth centuries in the Arabic period, in the western world knowledge of astrology had been either forgotten, or relegated to the realm of the "evil and forbidden". However, in the tenth century, Arabic astrological works began to trickle into the Eastern Roman Empire at Byzantium, where numerous works were translated into Greek. These included not only the original Hellenistic works that had gone through Persian and Arabic translations, but also the new works of the Arabic astrologers themselves. Astrology consequently flourished in the court of the Byzantine emperor Manuel I (1143–1180 CE), who used it extensively in his political affairs, even composing a Christian defense of the subject.[3]

Meanwhile, in the west, the wealth of the Arabic astrological literature had found its way to the Moorish libraries and bookshops in southern Spain. When Latin Christendom conquered Spain in 1085, European scholars flocked to Spain to partake of the Classical heritage that had been preserved by the Arabs as well as the Arabs' own rich intellectual tradition. Again, the very first works to be translated were the astrological treatises that cited the works of the Hellenistic authors. Soon after, Medieval astrologers began to compose their own compendia.

Among the scholars who produced the first translations of Arabic astrological texts into Latin were John of Seville, Hugo of Santella, Plato of Tivoli, Hermann of Carinthia, and Robert of Chester. Abraham ibn Ezra, a Spanish Jew, translated the Arabic and created his own texts in Hebrew.

MEDIEVAL/BYZANTINE ASTROLOGY (1200–1500 CE)

At the beginning of the twelfth century, there was virtually no technical knowledge of astrology in western Europe. However, by the end of the century, there were hundreds of translations as well as new works by Latin astrologers. The Me-

2 English translations of many of these works are now available through the efforts of Benjamin Dykes through Cazimi Press.

3 Demetra GEORGE, "Manuel I Komnenos and Michael Glykas: A Twelfth-Century Defense and Refutation of Astrology" in *Culture and Cosmos* (Autumn/Winter 2001, Spring/Summer 2001, Spring/Summer 2002). Demophilus is the name of a Byzantine astrologer working in Constantinople from the tenth century and John Camaratus wrote an astrological treatise in the court of Manuel I.

THE TRADITIONAL SIGNIFICATIONS OF THE PLANETS

> The Sun signifies the matters concerning soul, the Moon that concern the body, Saturn possessions, Jupiter money, Mars military matters, Venus matters of desire and partnership, Mercury custom and character and speech.—TEUCER OF BABYLON.[2]

Each planet has a basic nature that is expressed on several different levels of reality. From a cosmological perspective that envisions the world as ensouled, the planets represent the gods, who mediate and transmit the energies of the divine realms to mortals, regulating and governing human life. Each planetary god represents some faculty of the soul which links human consciousness to divine consciousness. In accordance with the principle of "as above, so below", as the planetary energy descends and becomes more coalesced into physical form, a planet likewise represents certain human character traits, parts of the body, types of people, occupations, and concrete objects. The Hermetic principle of correspondences links each planet to entities in the plant and mineral kingdoms, such as specific herbs and flowers, stones, colors, metals, and tastes, geographical areas, a day of the week and hours of the day. And in a more scientific conception of the astrological cosmos based upon the Aristotelian principles of natural philosophy, each planet is understood as some combination of the four qualities of hot, wet, cold, and dry.

Each planet had authority over one of the seven days of the week, as well as over the hours of each day. The Sun had authority over Sunday, the Moon over Monday, Mars over Tuesday, Mercury over Wednesday, Jupiter over Thursday, Venus over Friday, and Saturn over Saturday. The first hour of each day, beginning at sunrise, was governed by the planet that ruled that day. The subsequent hours were then subdivided with each planet, in turn, having authority over a certain portion of the day, based upon the Chaldean order of the planets—Moon, Mercury, Venus, Sun, Mars, Jupiter, and Saturn.

The planetary ruler of the day and executor of the hour were considered in all kinds of astrological inceptions (electional charts) in the determination of auspicious times to initiate events. The planet ruling the day and hour at which a person was born was also a consideration in natal charts. In addition, planetary days and hours were an important component of astral magic rituals in which invocations and supplications were made to the planetary gods on the day and

2 CCAG 9.1.2, p. 181.

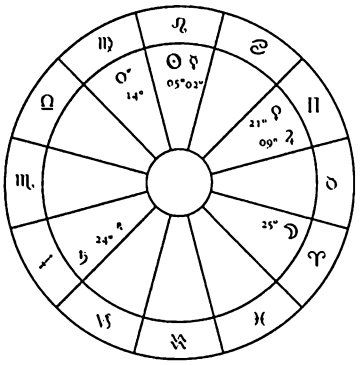


FIGURE 44. VOID IN COURSE MOON (MEDIEVAL & MODERN)

The Moon will not make any applying aspects before it leaves its sign (Aries). The Moon at 25° Aries made its last aspect to Saturn at 24° Sagittarius. Because it will not make any more aspects while it is in Aries, it is considered to be void in course according to Medieval and modern definitions. The Hellenistic definition, however, allows the Moon to cross sign boundaries for an interval of up to 30°. Thus, in the above chart, when the Moon enters Taurus, it will make a square to Mercury at 2° Leo; therefore it would not be considered void in course according to the Hellenistic definition.

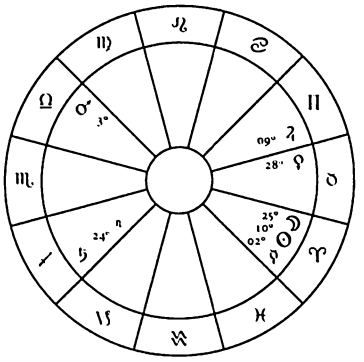


FIGURE 45. VOID IN COURSE MOON (HELLENISTIC)

The Moon will not make any applying aspects for the next 30°. The Moon's last aspect while in Aries was a trine to Saturn at 24° Sagittarius. Once it enters the next sign, it has until 25° Taurus to make an applying aspect to another planet. While in Taurus, it will be in aversion to planets in Sagittarius (Saturn), Libra (Mars), Gemini (Jupiter), and it has already separated from its conjunction to the Sun and Mercury in Aries. Its allowable interval expires at 25° Taurus, and so the conjunction to Venus at 28° Taurus is beyond the allowable orb. Thus, this Moon is void in course according to the Hellenistic definition.

futility and annulment, and turning back from that same purpose, and the impediments of that same purpose.[10]

The Hellenistic void in course condition is relatively rare, since the Moon has the opportunity to make contact with another planet for a 30° range that can cross sign boundaries. One of the most fundamental interpretative meanings for a void in course Moon is the lack of connection and subsequent alienation or isolation that a person can experience as the predominant feature of their emo-

10 IBN SAHL, *The Fifty Judgments* 6.